

When the music died

Q. Whenever I play an MP3 file on my laptop, there is an interruption at the beginning of the song and then it continues to play. If I stop and replay the song, it runs fine. My laptop is a Compaq Presario with a 533 MHz AMD K6 and 96 MB of RAM and I have the latest versions of MusicMatch Jukebox and Windows Media Player. I've redownloaded some songs, updated the drivers and even defragmented and scanned my hard drive for errors, but the problem persists.

Swadesh

Via e-mail

A There's nothing wrong with your laptop or your media players, except for the fact that your laptop is



just too slow—the specifications you've listed are the minimum requirements for running MusicMatch Jukebox and Windows Media Player. And remember, like Zip files, MP3s also have to be decompressed before they can be played—this process can be quite taxing for an older processor running a new, resource-hogging media player while simultaneously running other software in the background. You can verify this by playing some of your MP3s on a faster desktop PC.

To solve your specific problem, try running a light and no-frills software MP3 player such as Sonique (www.sonique.com) on your laptop. Also remove unnecessary applications from the System Tray so that they don't load automatically at startup—for instance, you could temporarily disable some applications such as the anti-virus program and the IM. Go to **Start > Run** and type **msconfig**. Click on the Startup tab and uncheck anything you don't want to automatically launch (you can always enable these later).

These steps should help you squeeze out enough power from your laptop to play your songs.

ing. If the motherboard has an onboard speaker, enable it; if the speaker is external, ensure it's plugged in so that you can hear if you are getting a POST beep code error.

No arrows

Q. How do you remove those ugly little arrows that appear over icons in Windows 98?

Username

Via e-mail

A It is very simple to get rid of the shortcut arrows. Just download TweakUI from Microsoft's Web site (you can get the Windows XP version at www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/pro/downloads/power toys.asp).

After installing TweakUI, launch the program and open the Explorer tree and then the shortcut selection. Change the Setting from 'Arrow' to 'none'.



Send your computing problems to sos@jasubhai.com or write to Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar, MIDC, Nerul-400 706, and we may answer it here!

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